Humana. Claims Payment Policy

Subject: Laboratory – Pancreatic Enzyme Testing for Acute Pancreatitis

Application: Medicare Advantage Products
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Medicare Advantage Payment Policy

As a Medicare Advantage plan, we have developed payment policies to explain coverage more fully for services. The criteria outlined will apply to Medicare Advantage plans except when the procedure(s) has established criteria through the Original Medicare National Coverage Determinations (NCDs) and Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs) as outlined below.

In addition to this policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

- Measurement of either serum lipase (CPT code 83690) or amylase (CPT code 82150) concentration for the initial diagnosis of acute pancreatitis **IS REIMBURSABLE** for individuals presenting with any of the following signs and symptoms:

  - Abdominal distention
  - Abdominal pain
  - Abnormal weight loss
  - Acute pancreatitis
  - Anorexia
  - Cullen sign
  - Diarrhea
  - Fever
  - Grey Turner sign
  - Hypoactive bowel sounds
  - Hypotension
  - Hypoxemia
  - Ileus
  - Nausea or vomiting
  - Tachycardia
  - Tachypnea

- Measurement of either serum lipase (CPT code 83690) or amylase (CPT code 82150) concentration **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE** more than once per week.

- Measurement of serum amylase (CPT code 82150) concentration **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE** when billed in conjunction with serum lipase concentration (CPT code 83690).

- Measurement of either serum lipase (CPT code 83690) or amylase (CPT code 82150) concentration **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE** in any of the following situations:

  – For all other situations or conditions not described above
  – For asymptomatic individuals during a general exam without abnormal findings
  – For individuals with a diagnosis of chronic pancreatitis

- Measurement of serum or urine trypsin, trypsinogen or trypsinogen activation peptide (TAP) (CPT code 83519) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE** in any of the following situations:

  – For asymptomatic individuals during a general exam without abnormal findings
  – For individuals with a diagnosis of acute pancreatitis

- Measurement of the following biomarkers with a diagnosis of acute pancreatitis **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE**:

  – C-reactive protein (CRP) (CPT code 86140, CPT code 86141)
  – Interleukin-6 (IL-6) (CPT code 83529)
  – Interleukin-8 (IL-8) (CPT code 83520)
  – Procalcitonin (CPT code 84145)

Applicable procedures for Medicare Advantage plans

Procedure Code	Code Description
82150	Amylase
83519	Immunoassay for analyte other than infectious agent antibody or infectious agent antigen; quantitative, by radioimmunoassay (eg, RIA)
83520	Immunoassay for analyte other than infectious agent antibody or infectious agent antigen; quantitative, not otherwise specified
83529	Interleukin-6 (IL-6)
83690	Lipase
84145	Procalcitonin (PCT)
86140	C-reactive protein
86141	C-reactive protein; high sensitivity (hsCRP)

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